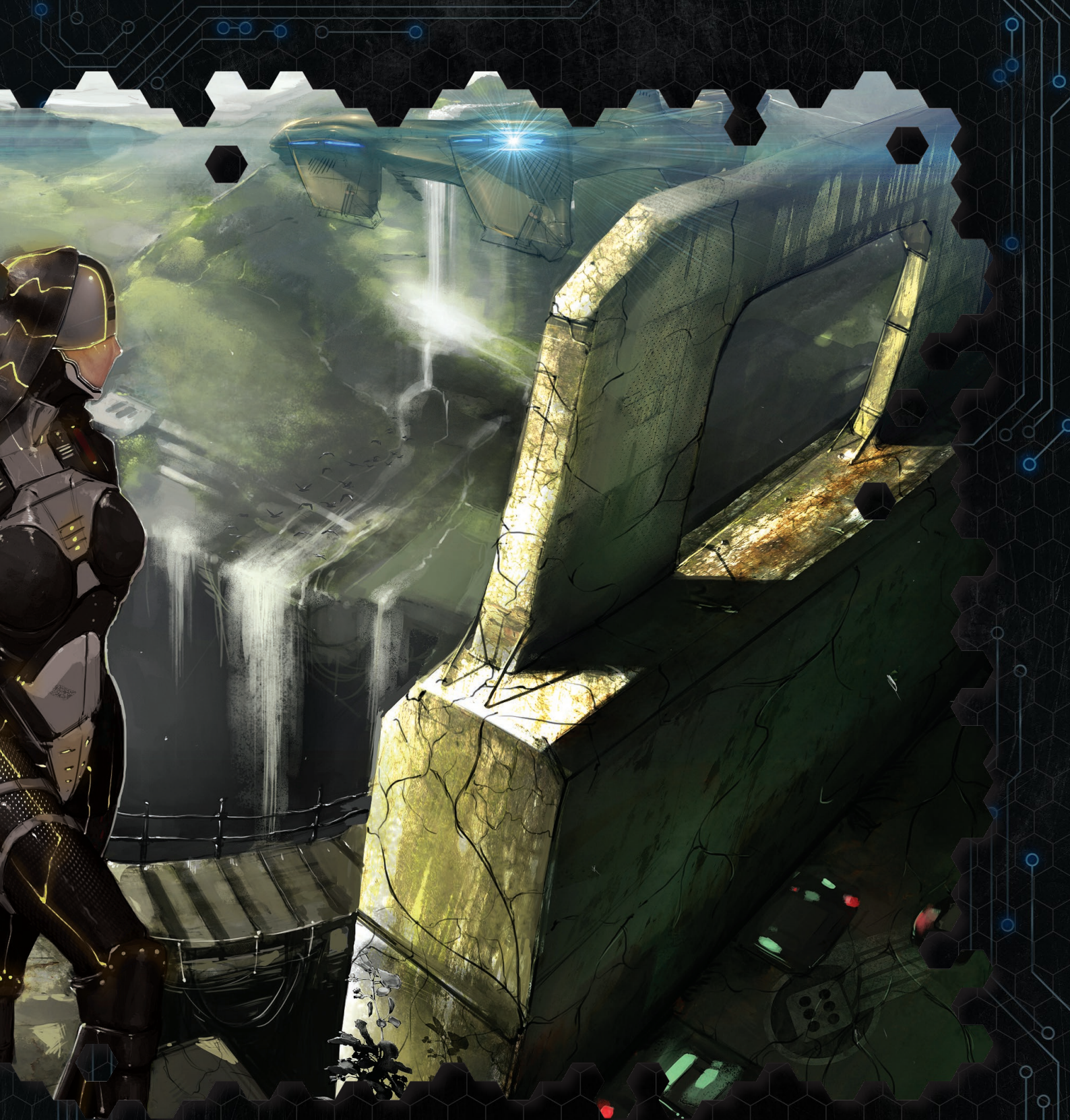




Deonysia stepped carefully over the crumbling ruins. She moved pointedly, each footstep processed deliberately. A thousand individual calculations were done with each small movement. However, each of these decisions was made subconsciously, the processing running far in the background of her thoughts, handled at such speed that it was imperceptible to all but the most careful observer.

She'd made the upgrades to her motor functions over several years. The physical improvements were required for her position and fairly standard of any PHR infiltrator, but the personal touches she'd made to the firmware were a work of pride.

It was this pride that put her in the position she was in. With such finely tuned skills, she was the obvious choice and accepted the position without a second's deliberation. Her observations had given her superiors unparalleled information about Earth. Delivered to them through mental uploads run through hundreds of relays, Deonysia's work would prove invaluable now that the invasion had begun. This was what she had spent the last years building toward. Yet the initial landings in the outskirts of Rio de Janeiro were by the Colonials.



As she watched the dropships over the decrepit city streets her motion tracking zoomed in on a pilot. With just a thought she was now glimpsing inside the cockpit from all the way across the valley. She scoffed at the blustering motions the pilot was making – his arms flailing without purpose as he reached for control panels. Deonysia had a bitter taste in her mouth thinking about the days before her first upgrades, before The Binding. Why the Colonials would want to live like that, she did not know.

As the dropship came in to land on the overgrown roads Deonysia felt the familiar itch at the back of her mind. Something she hadn't felt since being deployed on Earth. It came flickering into light again after years of inactivity and her cognition chip picked up the signal as if it had never gone. The UCM may have arrived first, but the Republic was close behind.

POST-HUMAN REPUBLIC

A portion of humanity turned its back on mankind in the waning days of the last Golden Age. Over one and a half centuries later, the PHR emerged from the shadows as an unrecognisable civilisation, its people irrevocably changed. They are no longer simple human beings, they are post-humans – cyborgs.

A society no more than three billion strong, the Republic is a nation of elites, each individual more than a match for several lesser mortals. With remarkable speed, they have made spectacular technological advancements. Since its fiery birth, the PHR has been guided by the enigmatic White Sphere, a mysterious object of immense power. It is treated by the people of the PHR with a reverence bordering on worship.

BIRTH

The Post Human Republic was born through the intervention of a mysterious alien AI, the White Sphere. Those that heeded its divisive warning of invasion chartered or seized thousands of starships. Those vessels able to break through planetary blockades and reach jump points translated to Vega IV, the indicated assembly point for all those that wished to follow The Sphere.

Their escape from the ruling government's fleet caused the infamous Battle of Vega. They fired on their pursuers, critically weakening mankind's fleet on the eve of the Scourge invasion. The battle was decisive and over extremely quickly.



The peacetime ships of humanity were built for pomp and grandeur more than military might, the fleets were splintered before the battle even began, and the admirals unused to full open warfare – a far cry from the militarised society that the UCM turned into. The battlefield was littered with broken ships, and the Abandonists jumped away, guided by coordinates shared by the White Sphere, and unknown to their pursuers.

That the PHR began with fratricide and betrayal was – they argue – a sad necessity, regretted but not atoned for. This group would be forever ostracised and removed from the rest of humanity, first ideologically, then physically.





EMERGENCE AND INTERVENTION

After the Battle of Vega, the Abandonists' fate remained a mystery, until the eve of the UCM's ambitious Reconquest campaign. A strange, unlooked for ship appeared over the UCM's capital Aurum, containing a delegation from the Post-Human Republic. This changed yet human group entered an audience with the UCM High Council and declared themselves technologically altered to a higher state of being, descendants of those that followed The Sphere.

Early relations were understandably soured by the actions of the Republic's forefathers. In this well documented meeting, the PHR delegation refused to show remorse for their actions in the Battle of Vega, only sorrow at the extensive loss of life. The PHR has always considered those actions necessary, declaring those who made them pioneering heroes.

No accord could be found - the PHR's advice against the Reconquest was ignored. Ever since, the Republic has conducted various operations in every theatre of the conflict. These include surface raids on specific and unknown targets, interdiction and disruption strikes and even a full-scale conquest of the Tlalocan Moons Cradle World system. What their goals are remains unknown. UCM analysts believe they may have huge bearing on the future of mankind, that the Republic's intentions may be pivotal to the outcome of the Reconquest, and perhaps much more.

Citizens of the Republic have nearly as many reasons to despise the Scourge as the UCM. While they escaped the horrors of invasion, they were still forced to abandon their homes. This may have influenced the recent alliance offered to the UCM in the build up to the Battle for Earth. This added the Republic to the uneasy coalition between the UCM and Kalium, known as the Triumvirate. While the Republic refused to share its motives, it seems it does not want the home planet in the hands of the vile aliens any more than the other humans. Tales of Earth are almost as commonplace in the PHR, a fact often forgotten by those who claim the Republic cares little for the future of the cradle of mankind.

Despite this, there is little common ground between the two halves of humanity. Records of PHR fleets attacking UCM vessels without warning mean many Colonial captains will happily fire on PHR ships with the slightest provocation, with understandable hatred for such traitors to the species.

The Republic has proven itself master of subterfuge and espionage. PHR intelligence gathering capability is likely far in excess of the UCM. Agents of the Republic have been known to turn Resistance groups on the Cradle Worlds towards their own purposes. Relations with the Shaltari are incomprehensibly complex and Machiavellian, with limited alliances between the scheming factions forming and breaking like waves on a beach. The PHR is highly adept at keeping its own secrets. Despite recent intel, it is a troubling fact that mankind knows less about the Republic than the Shaltari.



HOME SOIL

Where the White Sphere led the seed population of the PHR is an enigma. Ambassadors talk guardedly of “home soil”, implying the Republic occupies at least one planet. Several Office of Naval Intelligence initiatives have attempted to find these worlds, so far without success.

However, one nugget of intel did emerge from a recent mission – following a short-transmit node hidden aboard a PHR ship, a UCM Lysander class lighter jumped into utterly empty space, far outside the Milky Way. It detected traces of a second jump, but no node to follow, since the UCM’s secret short-transmit nodes can only burst once before burning out. The wildest theory suggests that since Foldspace drives don’t have infinite range, the PHR need multiple jumps to reach “home soil”. Since finite range in this context easily encompasses our own galaxy, this suggests the PHR homeworlds may be in another galaxy entirely. This is a staggering concept, since maximum range projections suggest it would take over 50 jumps to reach the nearest galaxy, fully three times the maximum service life of a UCM Foldspace drive.

If this is true, it would go a long way towards explaining the need for the PHR’s recent conquest of the Tlalocan Moons. In order to operate with any degree of efficiency, the Republic would need a base of operations near to Earth. Given the permanent surface structures and orbitals being built there, they appear to be preparing for the long haul, in any case.

THE WHITE SPHERE

The few certainties about this mysterious object’s physical nature can be found in the antique EAA Science Division records that survived the Scourge invasion, at least partially. It is said to be flawlessly white, apparently metallic, and about the size of a tennis ball. Its weight is staggering for its size, requiring the strength of two men to lift. This crude summary represents the extent of UCM intelligence. More detailed records may await discovery on Earth, should the allies triumph, although it must be assumed that the PHR will stop at nothing to keep such material from the hands of the UCM.

The Sphere’s technological powers are undoubtedly tremendous. It was able to decode and defeat the firewalls of every computer system on an entire sub-continent in seconds. It has been theorised that the Sphere utilised the vast bandwidth unlocked to download inconceivable amounts of intelligence. Many surmise that with every computer in South America in its grip, it would have been able to tap into humanity’s listening posts. Perhaps it saw something there that mankind missed. Others point out the all too coincidental timing of its arrival, asserting that it was planted to sow fear, division and uncertainty, softening up mankind’s defences. Others treasonously whisper that if all heeded The Warning, mankind would be in a very different, elevated state today.

Today, the White Sphere is central to the entire ethos of the Republic, although apparently in

an advisory role. Direct orders are issued by those elected to interpret its council. The world "Republic" indicates a democracy, although the choice of language by ambassadors suggests subservience to The Sphere.

Either way, the White Sphere occupies a revered position, determining many of the PHR's policies. Certainly, the Republic's technological superiority derives from the Sphere's apparently benevolent influence. The PHR has morphed from a desperate collection of mutineers and refugees into an unrecognisable society in less than 170 years, a feat only attainable with considerable assistance. For now, the White Sphere remains the greatest enigma to trouble the UCM.

POST-HUMANS

From the earliest encounters with citizens of the Republic, their changed nature was obvious. Their appearance, speech, movements and mannerisms were somehow uncanny and disquieting. Their claim to being more than simply human was never really in doubt. An immediate visual tell was the occasional flash of silver from below the skin. On closer inspection, their complexions were all too perfect and their eyes more piercing than the average person, often in hues seldom seen in nature.

Most citizens exhibit extensive use of cybernetic prosthetics and modification, for injury repair and/or improved physical performance. These vary from simple bone and limb replacements to incomprehensibly advanced bio-artificial melding of living tissue and fabricated nanostructures.

Subjects are usually at the height of physical perfection, despite the gnawing feelings of difference experienced by all who look upon them. Most UCM citizens who see them in person regard them as abhorrent and unnatural, a virtually distinct species to their own.

While no two individuals present identical enhancements, each obviously derives substantial benefits. Subjects have demonstrated improved mental aptitude and endurance, increased speed, agility and strength coupled with superior vision. While grievous wounds are just as fatal, merely debilitating injuries are seemingly ignored with ease, indicating a conscious control of the pain response.

They are also in close communion with their technology, commanding total control with the lightest gesture, often with no perceptible input. A deep empathy is also observed with others of their kind; a connection resembling the psychic at close distances. This is unmistakably electromagnetic in nature, as such abilities fail in EM shielded test chambers.

More disturbing still are the theories abounding those researching the PHR. Some claim that these almost too perfect creatures are merely ambassadors, the ones that have altered themselves to be most effective at dealing with humanity. Even the PHR envoys display unnerving alterations, but with the level of technology on display, it's theorised that citizens within the Republic are modified beyond recognition. Some claim that the diplomats and soldiers presented to the UCM are merely a picture perfect mask, with the true nature of their being carefully hidden beneath.



THE BINDING

The integration of the diverse artificial systems inherent in PHR physiology requires a complex web of connections to both each other and the organic systems of the patient. This is achieved through a network of advanced nanomachines binding to relevant biological aspects of the subject, the first stage in abandoning basic humanity. This process is referred to as The Binding, with the significance of an initiation right. Although several days of inebriation follow, the process is understood to be quite painless.

Although diplomats from the Republic have described this process in terms that suggest it is entirely optional, not a single unbound PHR citizen has been recorded. Maybe the benefits of The Binding are such that they outweigh a life without augmentation, but the lack of unenhanced individuals suggests that there is a stricter regime in play than the PHR would have the Colonials believe.

Regardless, only the bound are regarded as full citizens, from that time on known as post-humans. They can then explore the multitudes of artificial enhancements available, working on their bodies as an engineer might tinker with a race car. This is apparently deeply personal, with each modification selected by the user and apparently never forced on them. However, certain enhancements are present in every fighting PHR soldier, suggesting some are mandatory for military service. Differences between naval crews and ground troops have also emerged, indicating individuals choose or require enhancements to suit their vocation.





FAMILIARS

Most post-humans choose a sophisticated neural-linked communications suite, so they can commune with artificial intelligences known as Familiars. These devices take a wide variety of forms, from small domestic robots to personal transports and are central to the operation of the entire PHR. Developing affinity to them is considered a vital skill which can only be learned through years of practice. The most accomplished practitioners can communicate with dozens of such AIs simultaneously, massively enhancing their own potency.

There are even tales of spectacularly gifted individuals controlling whole swarms of drones and nanomachines, often to deadly effect on the battlefield. Such creatures are almost legendary, with the rare Medusa being the most feared and well documented by UCM ground forces. In the void, individuals of such potency would surely be a powerful presence, perhaps able to direct the artificial intelligences of an entire ship with pure mental agility.



UCM captured materiel:
Republic arm prosthetic.
Unknown composite.

THE GRAND FLEET

The Post Human Republic's Grand Fleet is a powerful force, but significantly smaller than those of the UCM and the Scourge. It makes up for this in sheer quality of crew and equipment. Earlier in the Reconquest it was thought to be tiny, the name "Grand Fleet" conjuring jokes among arrogant Admiralty staff. However, the Republic's actions in recent months have forced a revaluation - it is far larger than first thought. The stunning conquest of the Tlalocan Moons illustrates their potential for capturing and holding an entire Cradle World system, although few are currently privy to this incendiary information.

Actual estimations of tonnage vary hugely. The essential problem lies with the unknown reserves the Republic may have around their mysterious homeworlds. While it's assumed that most Scourge ships are currently in theatre due to the lack of reinforcements, the same cannot be said for the PHR.

Certainly, PHR fleets are highly advanced, although they follow familiar organisational structures. While the fleet assembled at the Tlalocan moons was as large as UCM Battlefleet, taskforce-sized fleets have been observed in other systems, such as Elysium and Shangri-La.

Smaller elements are routinely observed far from significant formations, illustrating their ability to perform effectively far from reinforcements or support, often for months at a time. Indeed, many PHR ship classes are designed with such operations in mind, with the assumption that they will be outnumbered and thus should be multi-role, and above all, tough.



PHR GROUND FORCES

PHR ground forces are advanced, flexible bodies, favouring quality over quantity. The population of the PHR is estimated to be less than one sixth that of the UCM. To be an effective fighting force, the PHR values survivability and lethality, providing a matchless quality of training and equipment. With superior technology at its disposal, the Republic has proven highly successful in this. PHR forces have repeatedly demonstrated that they can hold their own against terrible odds. Man for man, the UCMA is no match for the Republic's finest.

The PHR follow a similar chain of command and force organisation to the UCM, given their common heritage. Terms such as "Division", "Battalion", and "Squad" are in regular use, although it seems certain that no military formations exist which are as vast as the Colonial Legions.

In many respects, PHR vehicles are similar to those of the UCM. They share common heritage, although PHR armoured units have evolved quite differently to their counterparts. Technological advancements and higher build quality generally make them superior in most respects. They are often outnumbered, but seldom outgunned. PHR vehicles are much more survivable than their UCM counterparts, covered in layered composites providing outstanding, lightweight protection..

The Republic still makes limited use of traditional treaded vehicles, and shares broadly similar troop delivery and extraction methods, supported by a series of dropships. These are larger and more powerful than their UCM equivalents, supporting the delivery of heavier loads to the combat zone.

Most PHR vehicles feature a single pilot in communion with a counterpart AI. This keeps of loss of life to a minimum, making best use of the PHR's limited manpower. This affinity requires decades of experience as a post-human to be effective. On the battlefield, the wireless Familiars common in civilian life are rare. However, all PHR vehicles with a living pilot are equipped with neural connections requiring physical contact. Their isolated on-board AIs provide tactical assistance in combat, including targeting and threat analysis, an effective pilot-machine union.

The most obvious difference between the Republic and UCM ground forces is the presence of the imposing battle walkers, coupled with a cleaner, more developed aesthetic. Battle walkers require a vastly complex web of systems to enable fluid movements and stable mobility. Considerable redundancy is built in, allowing

them to function after heavy battle damage. This makes battle walkers slow and expensive to construct, although cost never seems to be an issue with the PHR.

PHR gunnery is lethal and demands respect. A diverse array of specialist weapons are employed by mixed discipline frontline units. These provide unmatched flexibility, allowing a typically smaller PHR force to adapt dynamically in fluid combat situations, and to have the firepower to meet any threat.

Much like the UCM, the Republic makes large use of railguns, their premier anti-armour, kinetic energy weapon. They function in the same manner as UCM railguns, achieving a superior muzzle velocity with a shorter barrel. A wide variety of sizes and calibres have been observed, right up to the massive R7X-1 used in the Republic's Grand Walkers. There is even a multi-barrel variant known as the Rail Repeater, capable of a high rate of fire to be employed in an anti-air role. Its triple barrels pump out over 5000 rounds per minute.

The Rail Repeater has a lower rate of fire than Gatling-types though, which the PHR bring to bear frequently. Miniguns such as the RX-20 Exterminator can lay down punishing fire, met with smooth-bore cannons such as the RXs-120 Obliterator that provide withering sustained fire able to level structures. Conventional cannons are also sometimes deployed in a multi-barrel configuration, such as the Mjolnir artillery system.

Many PHR units take to the battlefield with various load-outs of stealth missiles. Advanced versions of traditional rockets, they have EM absorbent coatings, adaptive camouflage, thermal shielding and multi-spectra scramblers to make them extremely difficult to detect, offsetting their slower speed against active counter-measures. What the warheads lose in power is more than made up for in reliability to close in on their targets, although more deadly versions exist, such as the RN-2 Cloudspear missile.

Possibly the most advanced, outlandish "weapon" employed by the PHR are the Black Nanomachines. These tiny robots are deployed in clouds by hive structures on certain, rare vehicles. On contact with enemy vehicles, they get in through cracks and vision slits, causing havoc with vital systems and crew flesh, dissolving them to dust with a billion microscopic cutting claws.



BATTLE WALKERS

A common sight in the Republic's armies, these form the core of PHR armoured might. The most common Types are bipedal and almost 20 feet in height, allowing them to imperiously survey and dominate the battlefield, while crushing the twisted wreckage of their foes underfoot. Typically, battle walkers are powerfully built and able to withstand punishing fire.

Battle walkers have existed in human armies for centuries. However, these experimental war machines were expensive and thus restricted to specialised uses. Before the launch of its Anvil program, the UCMA deemed the costs unacceptable, electing to concentrate on proven, traditional tank designs, which can be produced in vast quantities. The PHR has no such requirements and its superior technologies, coupled with the greater potential of walkers, has led to their widespread adoption.

Each battle walker features an isolated AI core, an entity which forms a close bond with the living pilot. Through a deep affinity with their mount's Familiar, skilled pilots are able to guide their walker over rough terrain with unthinking ease and predatory poise.

A terrifying sight to their foes, a squadron of battle walkers dominates the battlefield in a way few other units can. Their superior mobility and elevated stance makes them a threat in virtually any environment, and their extreme toughness more than makes up for their increased visibility.

The PHR classifies its battle walkers into distinct "Types", ranging from the smallest Type-S, all the way to the massive Type-7 Behemoth.

The Type-S excels at high speed, scouting missions. The most common variant is the Janus, which is anti-tank and AA capable. The Hermes supports friendly units by disrupting their signatures, making them more difficult to target.

Type-1 is the most common chassis, featuring the anti-tank Ares, the anti-air Phobos, the all-purpose Styx, the anti-infantry Menchit variants. The Type-1 is a good all-round chassis, providing solid armoured protection, reasonable mobility and strong power generators. The Type-2 is a slightly heavier chassis, trading speed for toughness. The anti-tank Odin, the tank-destroyer Hyperion, the command Zeus and the anti-structure Enyo feature expanded power generators, permitting the use of more potent weaponry.

In difference to the Type-2, the Type-3 is a lightweight but still full height battle walker, optimised for speed over survivability. The Apollo features good firepower but more uniquely, jump-jet capability. The Erebus features identical firepower but also a Disruption Field Generator, which interferes with EM systems of nearby enemy units. This chassis also has a sub-type, the 3X, which includes the command-equipped Hera, a heavier, up-gunned version of the Apollo.

Finally the Type-4 is an extremely large, 6-legged walker chassis with a distinctive tail-mounted weapon. This type is the largest not classed as a war engine. Its massive size permits delivery to the front by heavy dropship only. The Hades is armed with a Super Heavy Rail Repeater, two large miniguns and a nanomachine hive, allowing it to repair friendly units or insidiously attack enemy ones. The Nemesis is a command variant, armed with the formidable Nemesis Laser and two railguns.



JETSKIMMERS

Vehicles like the Angelos patterns of Jetskimmer behave very similarly to grav-tanks, although they are not quite so advanced. Instead, they lift off the ground using conventional thrusters. They are, however, tougher than the grav-tanks employed by the Scourge or Shaltari.

The Helios eschews troop capacity for ammo capacity, to feed its Galaxy multi-missile system, equally capable of downing aircraft and overwhelming tanks with weight of fire. The Aether is more unusual in that it carries a nanomachine hive, although it only contains offensively-oriented bots, making this a dangerous, illusive killer.

TREADED VEHICLES

The PHR makes use of several traditional treaded vehicles, although normally in support or auxiliary roles. The Juno APC is the most common, and the chassis can come armed with artillery, such as the missile-equipped Taranis MLRS. The Thor bombard also uses this platform, and both units are designed to strike at targets indirectly, keeping their relatively vulnerable hulls out of enemy fire.





INFANTRY

The basic frontline PHR infantry soldier is superior in every way to a Legionnaire. Known as Immortals, these warriors come equipped as standard with auto-sensing rifles and full plate body armour. Coupled with their cyborg augmentations, they are far more resilient than ordinary troops. They are armed with the RXp-57 'Dragon' Auto-sensing Personal Weapon, an electronic, variable rate assault rifle. It is equipped with a neuro-linked sensor suite, giving the cyborg operator a "gun's eye view", which allows the weapon to be fired from the hip, around corners or from cover without exposing the head. This link requires nothing more than physical contact with the grip, which has no trigger - discharge and rate of fire is controlled mentally. A smaller calibre, submachinegun variant, the RXp-9, also exists, famously employed by Valkyrie squads.

Immortals may instead carry an RXp-14 'Longreach' Auto-sensing Anti-Materiel Rifle, which serves the dual roles of vehicle hunter and sniper rifle. Using depleted uranium HV ammunition, it delivers considerable energy

for its size. It generally achieves vehicle kills through extreme accuracy, targeting weak spots in armour. Its use as a sniper rifle is well documented - kills have been reported at distances of over two miles by Immortals wearing adaptive camouflage cloaks, concealing them from return fire.

Similarly armoured but also equipped with jumpjet packs, Valkyries are highly mobile shock troops, able to fly between buildings and attack where they are least expected. More focused towards the anti-infantry role, Valkyries are consummate close quarters troops.

The most elite branch of the PHR infantry are the elusive Sirens – extremely gifted individuals able to best meld with PHR cyborg technology, making them especially effective close combat killers. Curiously, it is almost always women who attain this level of mastery. Rarer still are the true masters of the art of familiar affinity, the legendary Medusa. These Sirens are able to control and ride into battle on swarms of drones and nanomachines, unleashing them like a sea of metallic death against infantry and tanks alike.

DROPSHIPS

The standard PHR assault delivery aircraft is the Neptune medium dropship. This can carry a pair of treaded vehicles or Type 1-3 battle walkers. The Neptune is tougher than the UCM's Condor and better armed, though slightly slower. A different aircraft with the same capabilities, the Aegaeon, is also known to exist but is far rarer.

The PHR's heavy dropship is the Poseidon, with triple the capacity of the Neptune. Again, it offers superior protection and firepower to most equivalents in other races. A variant known as the Njord also exists, which replaces a third of its transport capacity with enormous ground attack missile pods. It might also be classed as a gunship, but it can still carry four vehicles into combat.

The PHR's light dropship is the Triton. It is a highly flexible platform that can be up-gunned to near gunship levels if required, without sacrificing transport capacity. Tritons can ferry infantry, walkers, Mercury Drones, or even a Medusa and her familiars to the heat of battle.

AIRCRAFT

Since all PHR dropships offer anti-tank firepower, the dedicated gunships are somewhat uncommon in PHR armies. However, when they do appear, they are formidable. The smallest is the Pallas – based on the Triton airframe, this forgoes all transport capacity in favour of further stealth missiles. The largest PHR gunship is the awesome Tiamat. Based on the Poseidon airframe, this replaces all transport capacity with a pair of colossal Super-Heavy Railguns, making this a powerful large vehicle hunter.

The PHR's standard high-speed aircraft is the multi-role Athena heavy fighter. Tougher than most equivalents, it is also faster when in supercruise mode, making it very difficult to down. Armed with a pair of Rail Repeaters, it is one of the most dangerous interceptors in the Reconquest. It also carries two stealth cruise missiles on under-wing hardpoints, for anti-tank and anti-structure capability.





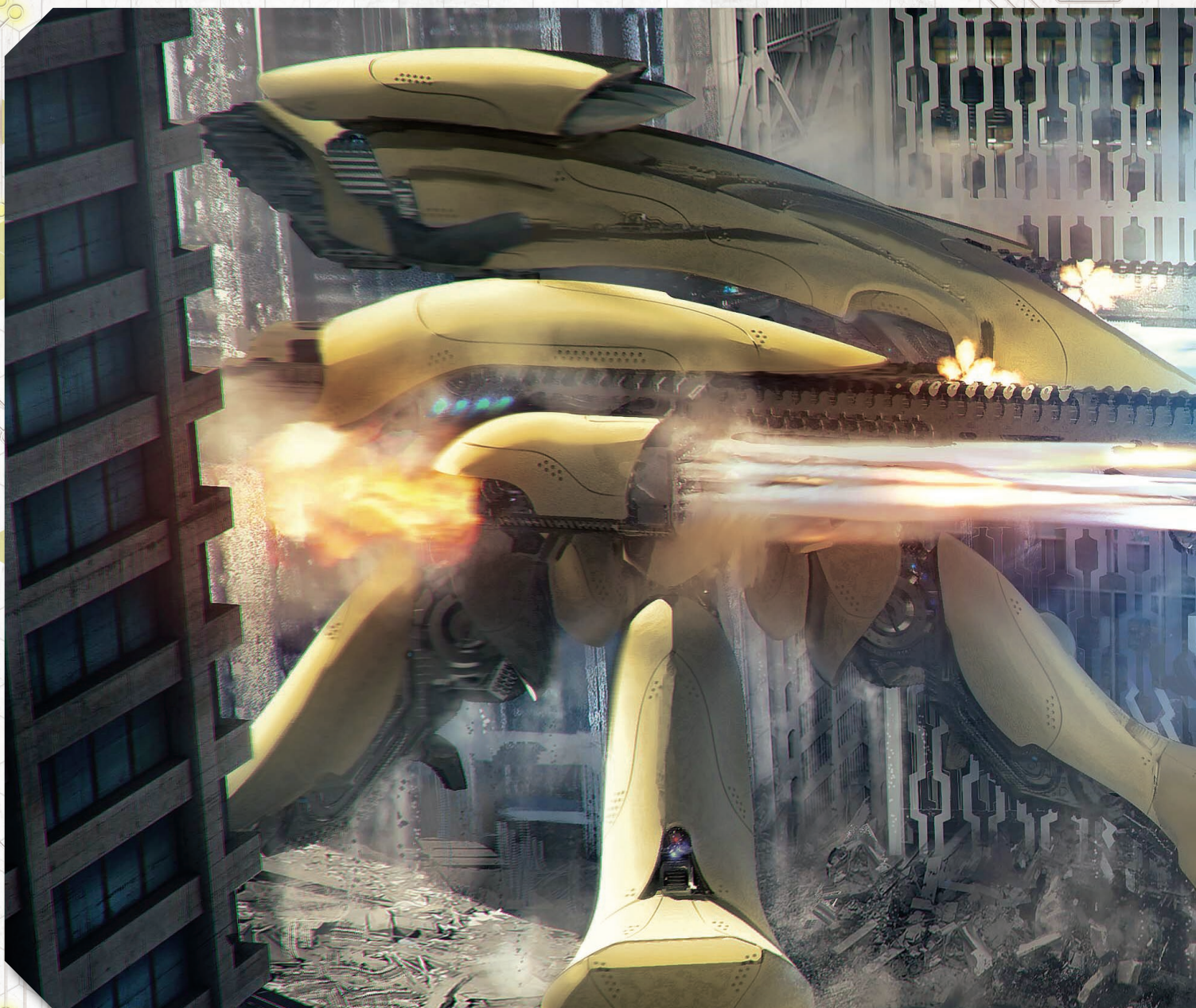
BEHEMOTHS

PHR Behemoths are, predictably, as tough as they are advanced. As designs, they are more mature than their UCM equivalents, since the Republic embraced the concept of these massive engines far earlier in their history. Behemoths fit perfectly with the PHR war ideology given their superior technology and low population, since these avatars of destruction give a small crew company-level firepower. This crew varies between three and four individuals, in close communion with each other and the Behemoth's on-board AI.

There have been rare sightings since the earliest days of the Reconquest, though they are only now being observed by common troops during the Battle for Earth. Most of what the UCM knows about PHR Behemoths comes from the observations of MF-B Team-6, sent to observe the Republic's conquest of the Tlalocan Moons. Given the scale of the invasion, many of these massive vehicles were deployed there, to devastating effect.

The Republic deploys its Behemoths either by Bulk Lander or Drop-Harness – the latter being intensely scrutinised and replicated by the UCM. The Drop-Harness is a detachable, short-burn thruster pack which arrests the freefall of a war engine dropped from a Strike Carrier high above. This burn expends the vast majority of the harness' fuel, leaving just enough for it to return the Carrier but no way near sufficient to lift the Behemoth back up.

All PHR Behemoths share technology with their smaller cousins, the Battle Walkers. Indeed, the PHR uses the same "Type" system to designate them, indicating that they consider them simply larger branches of the same tree. Known as Grand Walkers, their sheer scale allows them to carry some of the most formidable weapons the Republic can field.



TYPE-6 GRAND WALKERS

The Type-6 is somewhat smaller than the Type-7, though still enormous and powerfully built. This design is quadrupedal, with a low centre of gravity and bulky hull.

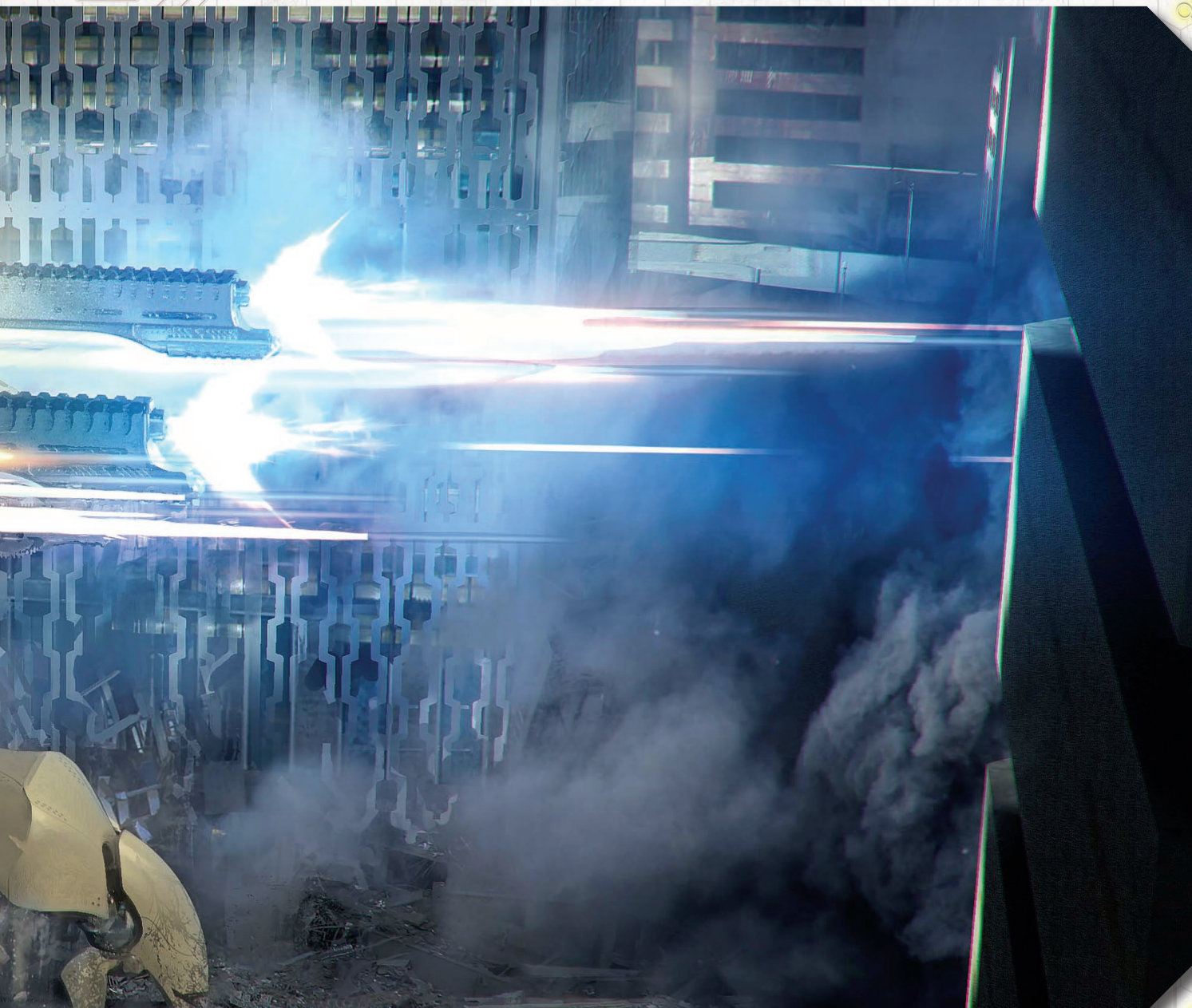
Both known variants include an integrated launcher for anti-Behemoth Nova-L stealth missiles, smaller versions of those carried by the Type-7. They also include three RX-1 Railguns on a chin mounted turret – tertiary weapons for such an engine, but equal to the firepower of three Type-1 Battle Walkers.

Of the two known variants of the Type-6 the Alcioneus is the more conventional of the two, being armed with a pair of flank-mounted R6X-1 Railguns. Smaller than those mounted on the Cronus class Type-7, these are still devastating, high-energy weapons best employed against other Behemoths.

The Porphyron is much more unusual, in that it acts as a base for eight large Venus drones. These are remotely controlled familiars as opposed to fully independent. They share several technologies with PHR Jetskimmers, acting more like grav-tanks than aircraft. They are anti-tank hunter-killers, armed with a pair of RX1-L Railguns apiece. Since they can operate out of visual range, this makes the Porphyron a potentially challenging target for something so large. The Venus drones also have the potential to engage enemy Behemoths up close, since each carries a high-energy Fusion Mine.

TYPE-7 GRAND WALKERS

These are the very largest PHR Behemoths. They have five identical legs and a 360 degree rotatable torso, allowing flexible motion, since there is never a true “front”. These legs offer excellent flexibility, toughness and redundancy, since it can lose several legs and still remain combat-effective.



Both currently known variants of the Type-7 share certain weapons systems. Most obviously, a back-mounted pod, containing three enormous Nova-Missiles: high energy, stealth-capable munitions designed for anti-Behemoth use. A chin-mounted pair of RX-30 miniguns provide close-protection against infantry insane enough to get too close.

The Type-7 has two arms, each of which mounts a primary, secondary and tertiary weapon. The latter may vary, suggesting pilots have a choice between the massive R7X-5 Rotary Cannon (anti-tank) or the R7X-66 Incinerator (anti-infantry).

The Cronus class Type-7 Behemoth has a primary armament of a pair of R7X-1 Railguns. While slightly smaller than the UMH-1 mounted to the UCM's America class, the PHR seems to favour additional weapons and flexibility over concentrated power. That said, the R7X-1 is still enormously dangerous, enough to take down any Behemoth in only a few volleys. The secondary

arm weapons of the Cronus are a pair of stealth missile clusters, best employed against swarms of medium vehicles.

The Tethys seems to be a much rarer class, employing a weapon experimental even to the PHR, known as the Sun glaive. As a type of directed energy weapon, it offers near infinite range. It may be fired in two patterns: focused or wide. The focused pattern is supremely accurate and absolutely unstoppable in penetrative ability. Virtually every shot is guaranteed to bore a neat hole all the way through any target. While conveying less residual energy to the target than the RX7-1, such reliability cannot be overlooked. The wide pattern fire mode has entirely different effect, reducing whole groups of armoured vehicles to molten glass and slag. The Tethys's secondary arm weapons are a pair of Black Nanomachine Hives, able to indirectly strike at enemy vehicles.